

Malaysian Peanut Chicken with Jasmine Rice and Stir-Fried Vegetables

Status: Stage 1 Draft
Weekly folder: `weekly-plans/2026/week-28/`
Category: Chicken
Source or inspiration: Next-week family menu idea
Date added: 2026-07-04

Planning Summary

- Servings: 4
- Estimated prep time: 20 minutes
- Estimated cook time: 30 minutes
- Protein: Chicken thighs
- Cuisine or flavor direction: Malaysian-inspired peanut sauce, savory, nutty, gently spiced
- Best day to cook: Wednesday
- Perishability notes: Uses fresh chicken and stir-fry vegetables. Good midweek.

Equipment

- Large skillet or wok
- Medium saucepan with lid
- Mixing bowl
- Whisk
- Cutting board and knife

Ingredients

Assume nothing is on hand. Include quantities for everything used.

Quantity	Ingredient	Preferred version/type	Acceptable alternatives	Notes
2 lb	Boneless skinless chicken thighs	Cut into bite-size pieces	Chicken breast	Main protein
1 tbsp	Neutral oil	Avocado or canola oil	Vegetable oil	For chicken
1/2 cup	Creamy peanut butter	Natural or regular	Crunchy peanut butter	Sauce
1/2 can, about 3/4 cup	Coconut milk	Full-fat canned	Light coconut milk	Sauce
3 tbsp	Low-sodium soy sauce	Low-sodium	Tamari	Sauce
1 tbsp	Fish sauce	Good-quality	Extra soy sauce	Optional but savory
1 tbsp	Lime juice	Fresh	Bottled lime juice	Sauce

Quantity	Ingredient	Preferred version/type	Acceptable alternatives	Notes
1 tbsp	Brown sugar	Light brown sugar	Honey	Keep less sweet than Thai peanut
2 cloves	Garlic	Fresh minced	1/2 tsp garlic powder	Sauce
1 tbsp	Fresh ginger	Grated	1 tsp ground ginger	Sauce
1 tbsp	Curry powder	Mild yellow curry powder	Malaysian curry powder	Sauce
1/2 tsp	Ground turmeric	Ground	Skip if unavailable	Color and flavor
1/2 tsp	Ground cumin	Ground	None	Sauce
1/2 tsp	Ground coriander	Ground	None	Sauce
1 tsp	Chili-garlic sauce	Sambal oelek or chili-garlic sauce	Sriracha	Optional heat
1/2 cup	Water	Warm	Chicken broth	Thins sauce
1 1/2 cups	Jasmine rice	Dry	Long-grain white rice	Side
2 1/4 cups	Water	Cold	Low-sodium broth	Rice
1/2 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Rice
2	Red bell peppers	Sliced	Any bell peppers	Vegetables
8 oz	Snow peas	Fresh	Sugar snap peas	Vegetables
2 large	Carrots	Thinly sliced	Matchstick carrots	Vegetables
1 tbsp	Neutral oil	Avocado or canola oil	Vegetable oil	Vegetables
1/4 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Vegetables
2 tbsp	Cilantro	Fresh chopped	Green onions	Finish

Basic Instructions

1. Start rice: rinse jasmine rice, then simmer with water and salt for 15 minutes. Rest covered 10 minutes.
2. Whisk peanut butter, coconut milk, soy sauce, fish sauce, lime juice, brown sugar, garlic, ginger, curry powder, turmeric, cumin, coriander, chili-garlic sauce, and warm water until smooth.
3. Cook chicken in oil over medium-high heat until browned and cooked to 165 degrees F, 8 to 10 minutes.
4. Add sauce to chicken and simmer 3 to 5 minutes, stirring often. Add splashes of water if it gets too thick.
5. In a separate skillet or after transferring chicken out briefly, stir-fry bell peppers, snow peas, and carrots in oil with salt until crisp-tender, 4 to 6 minutes.
6. Serve peanut chicken over rice with vegetables and cilantro.

Notes

- What might need testing: Peanut sauce thickness and salt level. Add water gradually.
- Possible substitutions: Use extra soy sauce instead of fish sauce if needed.
- Prep-ahead ideas: Whisk sauce and cut vegetables the night before.
- Family preference concerns: Keep chili-garlic sauce mild at first.

Review Link

Review file: